

Department of Mathematics and Applied Mathematics  
**3MS Metric Spaces**

**Tutorial 6**

**2024**

1. (a) Let  $d$  be the usual metric on  $\mathbb{C}$ , and let  $f : (\mathbb{C}, d) \rightarrow (\mathbb{C}, d)$  be given by  $f(z) = z + i$ .
  - i. Is  $f$  an isometry?
  - ii. At which points is  $f$  continuous?
- (b) Now let  $d$  be the metric on  $\mathbb{C}$  defined by

$$d(z, w) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } z = w \\ |z| + |w| & \text{if } z \neq w. \end{cases}$$

Again let  $f : (\mathbb{C}, d) \rightarrow (\mathbb{C}, d)$  be given by  $f(z) = z + i$ .

- i. Is  $f$  an isometry?
  - ii. At which points is  $f$  continuous?
2. (a) Are all isometries between metric spaces one-to-one?  
(b) Are all isometries between metric spaces onto?
3. Suppose that  $f, g : (X, d_X) \rightarrow (Y, d_Y)$  are continuous functions between metric spaces. Let  $C$  be a dense subset of  $X$ . Prove that if  $f(c) = g(c)$  for all  $c \in C$ , then  $f(x) = g(x)$  for all  $x \in X$ . You are showing that “continuous functions agreeing on a dense subset agree on the whole space.”
4. The proposition below is correct; we proved it in lectures. Explain what is wrong with this attempted simplified proof.

**Proposition** Let  $(X, d)$  be a metric space and  $X \times X$  have a metric which induces componentwise convergence. Then  $d : X \times X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is continuous.

**Attempted Proof**

Take  $(x_n, y_n) \rightarrow (x, y)$ .

Then  $x_n \rightarrow x$  and  $y_n \rightarrow y$ .

Then  $d(x_n, y_n) \leq d(x_n, x) + d(x, y) + d(y, y_n)$ .

So  $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} d(x_n, y_n) \leq \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (d(x_n, x) + d(x, y) + d(y, y_n)) = d(x, y)$ .

Similarly, by interchanging  $d(x_n, y_n)$  and  $d(x, y)$  one obtains  $d(x, y) \leq \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} d(x_n, y_n)$  and so  $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} d(x_n, y_n) = d(x, y)$ .

5. Let  $d_E$  and  $d_t$  be the Euclidean and taxi metrics on  $\mathbb{R}^2$  respectively, and define the function  $f : (\mathbb{R}^2, d_E) \rightarrow (\mathbb{R}^2, d_t)$  by  $f((x_1, x_2)) = (x_1, -x_2)$ , for  $(x_1, x_2) \in \mathbb{R}^2$ .
- (a) Is  $f$  an isometry?
  - (b) Is  $f$  continuous?
6. Let  $d_E$  denote the usual metric on  $\mathbb{R}$  or  $\mathbb{R}^2$ .
- (a) Show that there are exactly two isometries  $f : (\mathbb{R}, d_E) \rightarrow (\mathbb{R}, d_E)$  which leave a given element  $b \in \mathbb{R}$  fixed.
  - (b) Does the same result hold for isometries  $f : (\mathbb{R}^2, d_E) \rightarrow (\mathbb{R}^2, d_E)$ ?

The next two questions concern sets and set functions only; no metrics or continuity. Let  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  be a function from the set  $X$  to the set  $Y$ . Let  $A, A_i \subseteq X$  for  $i \in I$  and  $B, B_i \subseteq Y$  for all  $i \in I$ .

Recall that  $f(A) = \{f(a) : a \in A\}$  and  $f^{-1}(B) = \{x \in X : f(x) \in B\}$ .

#### 7. Properties of inverse images

Prove a selection of the following; enough so that you're comfortable you know how this works. You'll see that inverse images are very well-behaved.

- (a)  $f^{-1}(\bigcap_{i \in I} B_i) = \bigcap_{i \in I} f^{-1}(B_i)$
- (b)  $f^{-1}(\bigcup_{i \in I} B_i) = \bigcup_{i \in I} f^{-1}(B_i)$
- (c)  $f^{-1}(\emptyset) = \emptyset$
- (d)  $f^{-1}(Y) = X$
- (e)  $f^{-1}(B') = (f^{-1}(B))'$

#### 8. Properties of direct images

Direct images are not so well-behaved. Again, prove a selection of these; do at least one requiring a counter-example.

- (a)  $f(\bigcap_{i \in I} A_i) \subseteq \bigcap_{i \in I} f(A_i)$  but equality need not hold.
- (b)  $f(\bigcup_{i \in I} A_i) = \bigcup_{i \in I} f(A_i)$
- (c)  $f(\emptyset) = \emptyset$
- (d)  $f(X) \subseteq Y$  but equality need not hold.
- (e) There is no automatic relation between  $f(A')$  and  $(f(A))'$ .